Errors

שורה 53: התג <כלול-בהדפסה> חייב, שגיאה-1 – שונות/תרגומי-טקסטים-קדומים/history.md לעמוד לבדו בשורה, בלי שום טקסט נוסף לפניו או אחריו

History of the translation work

> Part of the guidelines for translating ancient texts (translation-guidelines.md), split out of it on 2026-10-21 to keep the core file lean. The rules distilled from these accounts are in the guidelines, §5.2: read them there. This file keeps the stories (what happened, with the examples), for when a rule needs its context.

H1. Working rules learned on the first corpus (2026-10-16; formerly in §5)

- **Draft unvocalized, in plene spelling (כתיב מלא), from the start.** Then vocalize names and ambiguous words. If you strip niqqud from a vocalized draft, you get defective spellings (`האדם`, `כסא`, `ודבר` for `הָאָדָם`). Also, a naive regex `[ִ]` deletes the maqaf (U+05BE); use `[ִ־]`.
- **Establish a line concordance** before translating any text that the literature cites by an older numbering.
- **Don't trust a lemma.** eBL and SEAL lemmatization have slips: e.g. XI 160 *attabak* lemmatized as *bakû*; SEAL *makkura* as *makkūru* instead of *makurru* "boat". Parse the form yourself before building a parallel on it.
- **Check the edition's translation against its own transliteration and commentary.** They sometimes disagree, so translate the transliteration and say so. The eBL composite sometimes follows a minority manuscript: record it.
- **Restorations can carry the parallel.** If a Genesis parallel rests on a restored word, say so in the parallels index itself.
- **Several texts of one corpus in parallel sessions:** fix the shared renderings before drafting, give each session a list of the lines it shares with the others, and re-sync at the end by exact string comparison. Lemma-level consistency matters too, not only identical lines.
- **Composite scores of many recensions** (e.g. SEAL): translate each score line from the oldest well-preserved witness. Put sense-changing variants in the apparatus. Number lines found only in later witnesses and tag them with their recension.
- **Translate the minor recensions too.** In the flood corpus, five of Genesis's "unique" details are each attested in a single small tablet, never in Gilg. XI.

- **Long texts with repeated passages** (learned on Enūma eliš, 2026-10-16): draft by tablet, **sequentially**, one translator at a time; fix the Hebrew of the longest repeated passage *before* drafting (it then binds every copy), and give each later translator the Hebrew of every earlier line that its tablet repeats. Use eBL's `Parallels:` field to list the repeated lines, verify them by script (identical Hebrew, or a difference justified by the Akkadian), and compare the normalizations first: eBL's "=" can join lines that share only a few words.
- **Brackets in repeated lines follow each copy's own manuscripts**: a word is in `[]` when its root (or most of it) is broken in all manuscripts of *that* copy, even if a parallel preserves it. Apply the rule to the transliterations (ATF), not only to the normalization: eBL's normalization sometimes brackets a word that one manuscript preserves.
- **Reserve the Hebrew word of a key Genesis comparison for its counterpart only** (e.g. `קָרָא` for *nabû* "to name" only; *šasû* "to cry out" = `צָעַק`), and avoid Hebrew words that share its root or letters (`נחת` beside `לִקְרַאת`; `נח` beside `קָרָא`).
- **Check every new Hebrew term against the Hebrew already used** (grep the `>` lines of all earlier files as strings), not only against the renderings tables: collisions are otherwise found only at review.
- **Compare the lemmas of identical repeated lines**: an eBL lemma slip in one copy (II 91 *šupurši* as "a spice") is exposed by the other.
- **Read the rank-3 translation as an echo check too**: a modern translation can import Genesis vocabulary (eBL's "firmament" for plain Akkadian words for heaven, Enūma eliš IV 141, V 121, VII 135), and its restorations can manufacture a parallel out of a lacuna (Foster's "[he shall rest]", V 142). Say so in the parallels index row.
- **Sumerian:** render narrative *marû* with the Hebrew participle as a default. Search ETCSL (TEI XML is lemmatized) for a formula before drafting a line, because formulas recur across genres. Map line numbers by gap arithmetic, checked against any line the literature quotes.

H2. Learned on each run (formerly in §5)

- **Learned on the creation and Eden companions (2026-10-17, seven texts):**
  - **Draft unvocalized from the very first line.** Two translators again drafted with full niqqud and had to rewrite by hand: put this rule first in every translator's brief.
  - **Grep the `>` lines for the roots of the key comparison verses and for reserved letter strings,** not only for reserved words: `עבד` entering through a frequent noun (*al-tar* "construction work", 7×), `ברא` inside `שבת` ,`בָּרִאשׁוֹנָה` / `בראותו` inside `דמות` ,`לשבת` inside `שדמות`. Fix the Hebrew of every frequent noun with this in mind.
  - **Reserve one Hebrew verb for the original verb of a key comparison verse and track it through the whole text** (Sum. *ĝar* / Akk. *šakānu* = `שָׂם` for Ex 4:11 `מִי שָׂם פֶּה`; *leqû* = `לָקַח` and *târu* = `שׁוּב` for Gen 3:19, 22): the strongest finds were verbal pairs invisible in English translations.
  - **Check the rank-3 translation's tenses and lemmas against the morph and the lemma:** ETCSL's "not yet" (three texts), "cursed" (an oath), "created" (a verb "to dwell") each manufactured a Genesis echo. ETCSL's own lemma sometimes contradicts its own translation in exactly the key line.
  - **Reserve `טוֹב` for the cognate** (*ṭābu*, Sum. *dug₃*) and give every other "good" adjective its own word; likewise `טֶרֶם` only for a real "not yet" construction, `לְעוֹלָם` never for *dārû* / *ṣâtu* (`לִימֵי עַד` ,`לִימֵי נֶצַח`).
  - **Describe a defect or a state as the original describes it** (Enki and Ninmaḫ's disabled people; Grain and Sheep's "bare limbs"), and put the biblical term (`עִוֵּר` ,`עֵירֹם`) in the apparatus.
  - **A single-witness passage has no variants, only readings** (two editors of one tablet); map a manuscript to the composite by its columns before speaking of a "version".
  - **When ORACC has no text, build a form index of the whole ORACC zip** (form → cf, gw, morph) and look up the text's verbal forms; mark the rest as our own analysis.
  - **Bilinguals:** translate the Akkadian, give the Sumerian in the apparatus, tag Sumerian-only lines `{שומרית}` (§6.8), and count the creation verbs per language: the ancient translators' equations (Sum. *mu₂* "grow" → Akk. *banû*; *tuku* "acquire" → *šubšû*) are evidence in themselves. An unlemmatised eBL ATF can be a base text: print our normalization beside it.
  - **Generate the annotated and clean files from one line-by-line data file** when possible (Adapa), so that `verify.py` only confirms.
  - **Read colophons and catch-lines as data:** KAR 4's Nineveh copy ends with the first line of Atra-ḫasīs.

- **Learned on Esarhaddon's Succession Treaty (2026-10-17, 691 + 443 lines, seven sequential translators):**
  - **When the Bible's own vocabulary is the natural Hebrew for the source** (treaty ↔ Deuteronomy), fix a **list of reserved Deuteronomic words** before drafting (`בְּרִית`, `סָרָה`, `כֹּסֶה`, `שָׁמַר`, `מָטָר`, `דָּבָר`, `שְׁחִין`, `אֲפֵלָה`, `בְּכָל לְבָבְכֶם`, `תֹּסֶף/תִּגְרַע`; later also `מָצוֹק`, `חֹסֶר`, `אָבָה`, `הַסִּית`, `מָנוֹחַ`, `תּוֹעֵבָה`, `יְבוּל`), keep them out of the `>` lines by script, and use a Deuteronomic word only for its cognate or exact equivalent, tagged. Otherwise the translation itself manufactures the parallels.
  - **Fix the split forms of every long formula**, not only the whole string: line breaks fall inside the formulas constantly. Vocalized first occurrences must strip to the plain plene string (`הַיְרוּשָׁה`, not `הַיְרֵשָׁה`).
  - **A formula/lemma check script** (`חוקים-ובריתות/1-אמנת-הירושה-של-אסרחדון/verify.py`) must strip brackets and tags, anchor lemma names (`adû[` inside `ḫadû[`), and list "identical normalization, different Hebrew" for review rather than as errors.
  - **Keep the oath form literally** (`אם אתם ... לא תנצרו`): Hebrew has the same elliptic oath syntax. NA oath clauses without *šumma* need `(אם)`; statements and plain prohibitions (no subjunctive *-ni*) need none; the SB curse list has none.
  - **A parallel copy found after the edition (Tayinat) must be compared with every `[]` of the composite**: it overturned several 1988 restorations, among them key words of Deut 28 parallels (440 rain; 470 blood; 658). Distinguish a *fill* (`{תיינת: ...}`, where the composite is broken) from a *plus* (an intact composite line lacks the word: apparatus only).
  - **Track Hebrew words across translators by Akkadian lemma**: two Akkadian verbs met in one Hebrew word (`קלה`, `קנה`, `דלת`) and had to be separated at the end.
  - **Read the etymology of the biblical word, not only its meaning** (*siāqu* ~ `יָצִיק`, Deut 28:53, hidden by Geers' law).

- **Learned on the Laws of Hammurabi (2026-10-17, 3,641 lines, twelve sequential translators in priority order):**
  - **When a text must be done in priority order, cut the annotated files by contiguous ranges and let a translator fill only some laws of a file**, with a placeholder comment (`<!-- טרם תורגם: §6–§13 -->`) in place of the rest; `verify.py` counts the not-drafted lines per file and fails only with `--strict`. One shared `lh_config.py` (files, topics, the composite parser, the witness alignment) keeps the data builder, the verifier and the translation builder in step.
  - **A common brief file** (in the scratchpad) read by every translator, plus a short per-run prompt with the block's key cases, kept twelve runs consistent; each translator grepped all earlier `>` lines and wrote its new strings as "Proposals" for the next.
  - **Check the class of every lemma in the whole text before reserving a Hebrew word for it**: `המית` was given to *dâku* Š in one block although *mâtu* Š (the cognate of `וְהֻמִית`) occurs nine times elsewhere; `משפט` was "reserved because LH has no *šipṭu*" – it has, once. Grep the normalization of the whole text first.
  - **One Akkadian verb ≠ the Torah's two**: LH has one goring verb (*nakāpu* = `נגף`, the cognate of Exod 21:35 `יִגֹּף`), Exodus two (`יִגֹּף` , `יִגַּח`); the pregnant-woman law uses *maḫāṣu*, while Exodus uses `נָגַף`. Such distributions are visible only if each verb has one fixed Hebrew rendering.
  - **The rank-3 normalization has slips** (CDLI: English words in the `ts` line, dropped words, *ina*/*ana*, wrong person): translate the transliteration and note it; check the composite against the main witness (the stele) by script.
  - **Formula checks must allow gender, number, the conjunction of a preceding *-ma*, and final letters** (`תקח` , `תהרג` , `תתן` , `ישלמו` / `ישלם` , `מחצ` / `מחץ`): the translators widened several patterns; write them that way from the start.
- **Learned on the Epic of Gilgameš (2026-10-17/18, 3,217 lines, thirteen sequential translators):**

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- **Reserve one Hebrew word for each Akkadian word of the key Genesis verses before the first tablet, and check the lemma behind every hit by script** (`אפוס-גילגמש/verify.py`, RESERVED: `טיט` only for *ṭiṭṭu*/*ṭīdu*/*ṭīdiš*, `עפר` only for *eperu*, ארר , `נחש`, and never , `טָרָם` , `עוֹלָם` , `עֵדֶן` , `כְּנֶגְדּוֹ` , `צֶבַר` , `פֶּתַר`). The check must accept eBL's lemma variants (*arru* for *arratu*, adverbs in *-iš*) – widen the allow-list rather than bend the Hebrew.
- **Ban the iterative paraphrase `שוב ושוב` when `שוב` is reserved** (for *târu* ↔ Gen 3:19): Gtn/Dtn/Štn = `פעם אחר פעם`, a doubled verb or a participle.

- **eBL's `Parallels:` field has false positional links** (I 254–265 → II 269–288; III 88 → V 137; VI 140 → 142, and others): treat it as a list to inspect, not as ground truth; compare identical normalizations across the corpus as a second net (`parallels_for.py` does both).
- **Read the transliteration before believing a coordinator's key line**: several prompts quoted the literature's paraphrase (OB III "I will establish my name" is *šumī lū ušzīz*; XII's god is Šamaš, not Nergal; IX's darkness is *šapât*). The translators followed the edition and said so; keep briefs to "look for", not "translate as".
- **Let translators generate the annotated and clean files from one data file** (most did, from scratchpad scripts): the clean file can never drift from the `>` lines.
- **Plene spelling of a vocalized fixed passage must be fixed once** (X 40–71: `עליי` , `פניי` , `זיווך`): later copies copy the plene first copy, not the vocalized table.
- **Merge each translator's proposals into the corpus renderings between runs**, numbered by run (`renderings.md` §9–§21), so later translators read one file; resolve collisions immediately (e.g. *wabālu* `הֲבִיא` vs *warû* `הוֹבִיל`).

- **Learned on the other law collections (2026-10-18, LE 195 + MAL A 828 + LI 503 + UN 628 + MAL B 245 lines, nine sequential translators):**
  - **One shared config and four generic scripts for several base texts** (`חוקים-ובריתות/laws_config.py` with CDLI and ORACC parsers, `laws_build_data.py`, `laws_verify.py`, `laws_build_translation.py`, `laws_lookup.py`) carried five projects; add a project as a `PROJECTS` entry, not as new scripts.
  - **CDLI exemplar ATFs carry `>>Q... <label>` links to the composite line**: use them for an exact line-by-line witness alignment (no difflib); a mistyped link (`07` for `070`) shows up as a line without witnesses.
  - **"Identical formula = identical Hebrew" across collections must be checked by lemma, not only by identical normalization**: the cross-collection identical-normalization check found almost nothing (different dialects and spellings), while a lemma-by-lemma lookup against LH (`laws_lookup.py`) changed several renderings. Give every translator the lookup tool and make "look it up before fixing a word" a rule.
  - **A Sumerian legal formula takes the Hebrew of its Akkadian equivalent** (*tukum-bi* = *šumma* = `אם`; *la₂* = *šaqālu* = `ישקול`; *ama-ar-gi₄* = *andurāru* = `דרור`; *ur₂* … *nu₂* = `בחיקה שכב`; *nam-tag il₂* = *arnam našû* = `עונו ישא`): the same law then reads the same in Sumerian and Akkadian, and the Sumerian–Torah contacts become comparable with LH's.
  - **Lemma-gated words** (`laws_verify.py` GATED: `בתולה` only for *batultu*, `זונה` only for *ḫarimtu* / *kar-kid* / *kar-ke₄*, `צעק` only for *šasû*, `המית` only for *mâtu* Š …) are the right tool when a Torah key word is also the natural rendering of its real cognate; widen the allow-list for spelling variants rather than bend the Hebrew.
  - **The rank-3 brief can be wrong about the tablet**: the coordinator's list named *zaqānu*, *kalūmā*, *ana niāke* in MAL A, which the tablet does not have (*gadāmu*, an iterative form, *ana mazāʾe*); the translators followed the transliteration. Keep briefs to "look for".
  - **Quote Deuteronomy 22 with the ketiv `נַעֲרָ`** (no ה), as `תנך-מנוקד/` has it.
  - **A composite without § marks** (Ur-Namma): head each law `## §N (a–b)` with the standard number where the content identifies it and `## חוק (a–b)` otherwise, keep a concordance table with a certainty column, and key the clean translation's topic headings by composite label (`'@b001'` in `laws_config.TOPICS`).

- **Learned on Bird and Fish and Enki and the World Order (2026-10-19, 189 + 465 lines, three sequential translators, EWO's key half first):**
  - **Find the formulas in the transliteration before fixing them in the renderings.** The coordinator pre-fixed an EWO appointment formula "*ugula-bi-še₃ ĝar*" from the literature's paraphrase ("placed in charge"); the text has *{d}en-ki-ke₄ zag-ba nam-mi-in-gub* "Enki set (him) standing at its side" 13 times, and the translator corrected it. Run `sumerian_workbench.py conc` on every formula you intend to fix.
  - **Keep the kind-word and the motion-word apart when the commentary's dictionary distinguishes them** (*mušen* = צִפּוֹר, *dal* "fly" = עוף ;עָף licensed by script only beside *dal*): the closest line to Gen 1:20 (B&F 129 *dal-dal* = מְעוֹפְפָת, the reduplication of Polel יְעוֹפֵף) became visible, and so did the fact that EWO never names birds by their flight.
  - **A reserved-string check must name the Sumerian word that licenses each string** (טוב only beside *dug₃*, כנף beside *pa* / *a₂*, ברך beside *šud₃* / *dub₃*): it caught ,(ברך) דברך (ברא) בראש and (רמש) סוחורמש in compounds, and it makes the distribution of טוב a finding (B&F: only the bird's voice is "good").
  - **Name traps are errors only when the transliteration has the name** (אותו is "him" unless *{d}utu* is in the line; איננה is "is not" unless *inana*); otherwise the check drowns in false positives. New traps: Urim אור ("light") and Sumer שׁוֹמֵר ("guard") must be vocalized.
  - **When the annotated files are drafted in priority order** (EWO 250–472 before 1–249), the verifier must treat a not-yet-written file as a note, not an error (`--strict` at the end), and the builder must skip it.
  - **Compare repeated lines after stripping brackets and quotation marks:** each copy brackets by its own manuscripts, so raw string comparison reports false differences.
  - **Tell translators the exact table format the corpus builder reads** (heading `### Parallels index (<Text>)`, columns `| Line | ... |`): a wrong format in the first brief had to be corrected mid-run.
  - **ETCSL's English again imported creation language** (EWO 361 "created" for *du₃* "build", 446 "create" for *sig₁₀* "put", "called" for *gu₃ de₂* "address", B&F 166 "like Enki" with no "like"): the corrected readings are findings for Gen 1, Deut 32:39, Isa 45:7.
  - **The *ḫe₂-* prefix is not always a wish**: with ḫamṭu in a list of what others received (EWO, Inana's complaint) it can be affirmative ("indeed she got"); the translator read it so against ETCSL's "is to get" and recorded the choice (project 4 open decision 4).

- **Learned on Ludlul bēl nēmeqi and the Babylonian Theodicy (2026-10-19, 534 + 288 lines, six sequential translators):**
  - **Fix a reversal passage in both directions before drafting it, nouns *and* verbs** (Ludlul II 51–57 ↔ III 69–75; the body of II ↔ the healing of III; I–II ↔ V): read the Akkadian of the later copy first (II's *lā nêʾi* "unreturnable" is answered by III's *utīr*, so II must not use שוב), and give the later translator a table of the earlier Hebrew *strings*, not only a lemma index. The cure then reads as the undoing of each symptom.
  - **The ancient commentaries are rank 4 for single words and expose lemma slips** (Ludlul K 3291, the Theodicy's BM 66882+): they decided a dozen renderings, distinguished homonyms the edition's lemma confused (*būṣu*, *mammû*, *ḫuršānu*), and their lemmata count as manuscripts for brackets. Quote them in the notes: they are also the ancient reading of the text.
  - **Check the coordinator's own tables with `check_bible_quotes.py` and against every corpus** before the first run: the pre-set renderings had seven misquoted verses and two terms already fixed differently elsewhere (*parṣu* / *pelludû* in Enūma eliš, *muštālu* in LH).
  - **A cross-language pun needs a method fixed before its first instance** (the twelve gates of Esagil, whose Sumerian names predict the gift received in each): transliterate, add a quoted Hebrew gloss worded with the Hebrew of the gift, same name = same gloss.
  - **Particles can be cognate where content words are not** (*lūman lā* = לוּלֵא, Ps 94:17; 124:1–3), and so can idioms hidden by English (*ana balāṭ* "next year" = כָּעֵת חַיָּה, Gen 18:14).
  - **A first draft must be unvocalized from the first line – again** (one more translator drafted vocalized and rewrote 134 lines): keep it the first rule of every brief.
  - **Do not open a translation intro paragraph with bold text** when a builder reads `label` lines as numbered lines.

- **Learned on the Lament for Ur and the Curse of Agade (2026-10-19/20, 442 + 321 lines, five sequential translators):**
  - **Pre-set the refrains, let the first translator revise them with a reason, then enforce them by regex** (`lament_tools.py` FORMULAS): run 1 corrected three of the coordinator's pre-set refrains (a `בְּ־` taken from ETCSL's "in"; a participle for a noun phrase; "his" for *-bi* "that"), and the script then held 35 + 23 + 34 copies identical across three files. Write the regex for plene and defective spellings and for the Emesal and main-dialect forms (`ני?גשה`; *nam* … *ku₅* and *na-aĝ₂* … *kud*; *mu(-un)-na-te*).
  - **Anchor gated strings at a word start** (`נכר` caught `נכרת` from *kud*) and **license them by every spelling of the Sumerian word** (*taka₄*, *tag₄*, *da₁₃*).
  - **When the Bible's genre-words are the natural Hebrew** (a city lament ↔ Lamentations), reserve them outright – `בַּת` , `גָּלוּת` / `גלה` , `שְׁכִינָה` , `כְּבוֹד` , `קִינָה` , `אֵיכָה` + a city – and render the Sumerian's own words (*a-gin₇* `איך`, *a-še-er* `אנחה`, *muš₃ de₆* `נטש`, *nam-dugud* `כובד`, *e₃* `יצא`). The parallels are then visible as [equivalent]s, and the absences (no exile word, no "daughter", no sin) become findings.
  - **The rank-3 English imported the Bible's theology, not only its words**: ETCSL's "righteous" / "innocent" (*zid*), "exiled" (*e₃*), "return!" (no verb), "before the time when cities were built" (no "before"), "tried to alter" (no "try"). Each corrected reading was a finding (no sin of Ur; the king's sin is disobedience to an omen, not pride).
  - **"The Sumerian takes the Hebrew of its Akkadian equivalent" makes cross-language cognates visible**: *u₈* = *laḫru* ~ `רָחֵל` (the ewe bereft of her lamb, Jer 31:14), *du₆* = *tīlu* = `תל`, *ad₆* = *pagru* = `פגר`, *kur₂* = *nakru* ~ `נכרי` (Lam 5:2), *ur₅* = *kabattu* = `כבד` (Lam 2:11), *nam ku₅* = *arāru* = `ארר` and *gi₄* = *târu* = `שוב` (Agade 231–236 ↔ Gen 3:17–19).
  - **A fragmentary earlier version** (the Ur III Agade) is translated as its own segments, mapped line by line to the later version (the first translator's content mapping was corrected by the second: check by script or by hand), identical Sumerian = identical Hebrew, and its *absences* are recorded (no explicit sin in Ur III).
  - **Do not open an intro paragraph with bold text** (a builder reads `**label**` as a numbered line) – repeated here because the coordinator made the same mistake again.

- **Learned on the Gudea Cylinders (2026-10-20, 1,300 lines, seven sequential translators):**
  - **When the Bible's building vocabulary is the natural Hebrew, reserve it outright** (`פָּתַר`, `תָּמִים`, `חָכַם לֵב`, `נְדָבָה`, `קֹדֶשׁ`, `כָּבוֹד`, `מְלָאכָה`, `תַּבְנִית`, `מִשְׁכָּן` …) and gate the words whose real counterpart exists (`צורה` *ĝiš-ḫur*, `מצבה` *na-du₃-a*, `פשר` *bur₂*, `מלבן` *u₃-šub*, `ארז` *erin*, `אמן` *um-mi-a*): the [equivalent]s and [divergence]s then appear in the apparatus (Ezek 43:11's `צורה` instead of Exod 25:9's `תבנית`; Daniel's `פשר` instead of Joseph's `פתר`; *ni₂ me-lem₄* where Exod 40:34 has `כבוד`), and ETCSL's "exactly as he had been told" (A xxiv 8) is exposed as a false echo of Exod 39:32.
  - **Use the literature's labels when the base text carries them**: ETCSL's `A1.1` labels equal RIME's column-line numbers; a concordance script (`temple_tools.py conc`) proved ETCSL = ORACC line for line before drafting, and the files use `A.ix.10` throughout.
  - **A gate needs every spelling of its licensing word in the base text, not in the coordinator's head**: `מצבה` was licensed by ORACC's *na-ru₂-a* while ETCSL writes *na-du₃-a*; `חלו?מ` missed the final mem of `פשר`; `חלום` refused the plene `פשור`; the `קדש` check caught `מקדש`, the `שוב` check `יישוב`, the `לבנה` ("brick") gate the adjective "white". Run the gates on a test line of each spelling before the first run, and write the formula regexes for final letters and plene spellings.
  - **Check headings for vocalization traps too**: the verifier checked only the `>` lines, and four section headings had unvocalized Utu, Bau, An, Magan.
  - **Translators quote from memory unless told not to**: one translator found ten placeholder or remembered quotations of its own (the quote checker sees only quotations followed by a reference); the brief must say "print every verse before quoting", and the coordinator should re-check quotations written as `` `…`, Book ch:v `` by converting them to the checker's format.
  - **Promise/fulfilment and command/execution texts** (Gudea A ix–xii → xv–xxii; A vi → vii; B ii's report = A ii's promise) gain from fixing the first copy's Hebrew and grepping it before each later copy: the fulfilment then reads as the promise "in the same words", which is itself a finding.

- **Run 5 of Round 2 (2026-10-21): the Descent of Ištar (eBL `L/1/8`, 159 entries) and Inana's Descent (ETCSL 1.4.1 / ORACC Q000343, 440 entries) in a new corpus `העולם-התחתון/`, translated by the coordinator himself (no sub-agent tool in this cloud session), the Akkadian first, then the Sumerian in two files; three review passes each; `netherworld_tools.py verify --strict` OK; parallels index generated from the annotations.** The corpus renderings fixed one Hebrew for the shared episodes of the two languages before the first line (*kur* = *erṣetu* = `הָאָרֶץ`, *ĝarza* = *parṣu* = `פָּלְחָן`, *al dug₄* = *erēšu* = `שָׂאַל`, the ornaments gate by gate, the water and plant of life), and copied the Gilgameš Hebrew for the lines the Akkadian shares with Gilgameš VII and VI. The strongest finds: the myth and the rite behind Ezek 8:14 (Inana weeps for Dumuzi; the Akkadian ends with the wailing men and women, *bakkāʾū u bakkâtu*); Job 7:9 as the law of both poems in the same verbs; the substitute ("one head in place of her head") against Ps 49:9; Song 8:6 acted out (the goddess of love gives her husband to death with the eye that killed her); Ereškigal as "the mother who gives birth, on account of her children" (Jer 31:14). Lessons: §3.2 above (stale pre-draft rows; grep the annotated lines; print every verse even in notes).

H3. Lessons learned (formerly §11)

- Search the **digital corpora first** (eBL, ORACC, SEAL, ETCSL). In 2026 they are often more current than any printed edition: eBL's Gilg. XI includes joins and NABU notes from 2026.
- Old translations differ from modern ones in readings, not just style (e.g. Nisir → Nimuš, Puzur-Amurri → Puzur-Enlil). Never take a reading from a pre-1990 source without checking the current edition.
- OCR of old transliterations is unreliable (diacritics, superscripts). Use the page images for anything that matters.
- **Clean-looking digital text is not verified text.** DFHG's Berossus silently dropped a printed line, the most important one for the comparison. Check against the page images.
- **Echo control produces real finds.** The standard English translations hide *kalû* / `כלא` (Gilg. XI 133b ↔ 8:2), *nâḫu* / `נח` (133a ↔ 8:4) and *sekēru* / `נִסְכַּר` (Atr. II ↔ 8:2). For each version, check every verb of the Genesis scene against the Akkadian lexicon.
- **A creation verb shared across a text is the strongest hidden echo:** in Enūma eliš *šubšû* "bring into being" is used for exactly the two objects of `בָּרָא` in Gen 1 (the monsters ↔ the tanninim; man). Look at the *distribution* of each key verb over the whole text, not only at single lines.
- **A name can be the hidden echo** (*Nannaru* "luminary" ↔ `הַמָּאוֹר`), and **lists of epithets are dense with cognates** (the fifty names: `אֵד`, `זֶרַע`, `דֶּשֶׁא`, `יֶרֶק`, `הוֹצִיא`).
- **Sequential sub-agents, one tablet each, with a coordinator review between them, worked** for a 1,098-line text: each received the binding renderings, the Hebrew of all earlier repeated lines and a list of the expected parallels; the coordinator merged their proposals into the renderings before the next tablet.

- **The rank-3 translation is the main source of false echoes in Sumerian** (creation corpus project 2): ETCSL's "not yet", "cursed" and "created" each sharpened a Genesis parallel that the Sumerian does not have; the corrected readings (plain negation, an oath, "dwelt") are themselves findings for the commentary.
- **One translator per text, sequentially, with the cross-text terms fixed before the first one and a coordinator review between them**, worked again for seven texts (Akkadian, Sumerian and two Sumerian–Akkadian bilinguals): each later translator was bound by the earlier ones' §4 rows in the project renderings and grepped their `>` lines.
- **Treaties are dense with idioms that survive word for word in biblical Hebrew** (לֵבָב שָׁלֵם, עִם, גָּלָה אֹזֶן, נָשָׂא רֹאשׁ, רָאָה אֶת שָׁלוֹם, בִּקֵּשׁ מִיַּד, הֵשִׁיב גְּמוּל) and in Biblical Aramaic (*karṣī akālu*): render them literally where Hebrew has them, and the match becomes visible.
- **Sequential sub-agents, one part each, with the formulas fixed before the first part and a coordinator harmonization at the end, worked a third time** (EST, seven parts); a part-data file per translator (composite + aligned copy + rank-3 translation per line) and a shared verify script kept 691 lines consistent.
- Tchernichovsky 1924 is a useful **negative model** for echo control: it has `מנוח לכף רגלה`, `ריח הניחוח` and `העולה` where the Akkadian has none of them.
- **Law collections hide their differences from the Torah in the small words** (LH, 2026-10-17): the passive `יהרג` against `מוֹת יוּמָת`, "like" against `תַּחַת`, the class terms, the one goring verb, the god's "blow" for an accident, *ina idû* "knowingly". Fixing these before the first law and checking them by script made the Covenant-Code comparison legible line by line (1,263 parallels rows).
- **Twelve sequential sub-agents in a fixed priority order** (frame first, then the most-compared laws, then the rest) finished a 3,641-line text; a coordinator pass between runs (resolving one collision per run on average) was enough to keep it consistent.
- **Thirteen sequential sub-agents, one tablet or tablet group each, in the user's priority order, with a written common brief and a renderings merge after every run, finished the whole Gilgameš epic (SB I–XII, nine OB tablets)** (2026-10-18). The strongest finds again came from fixed one-to-one renderings: `היה לטיט` / `היה לאדם` (OB II 108–109, X 68), `שמו מוות ... חיים ... אחזו` (OB VA+BM a+19–20; X 321), "eat and return to my youth" (XI 300: the two verbs of Gen 3:19), Job 4:13–15 in the incubation dreams of IV, and `אַעֲלָה לָךְ` in XII 8.
- **Six sequential sub-agents finished Ludlul I–V and the Babylonian Theodicy** (2026-10-19), with a renderings merge after each run (§10.1–§10.6 of the corpus renderings). Where the Bible's own register is the natural Hebrew (lament and thanksgiving psalms, Job), the lemma-gated reserved words (`קבר`, `טוב`, `ישר`, `רחם`, `עזב`) and the banned Job words (`צדיק`, `תם`, `גואל`) kept the parallels honest; the strongest finds were again exact phrases visible only through one-to-one renderings: Ps 27:10 `אָבִי וְאִמִּי עֲזָבוּנִי` (Theodicy 11), Ps 30:6 (Ludlul I 2), Job 23:3 `מִי-יִתֵּן יָדַעְתִּי` (II 33), Job 19:14 `קָרוֹבָי ... מְיֻדָּעַי` (II 120), Deut 28:47 `בְּטוּב לֵבָב` (II 25), Isa 42:13–14 (I 18).

- **Five sequential sub-agents finished the Lament for Ur and the Curse of Agade** (2026-10-19/20), with the refrains pre-set, revised by the first translator and enforced by script, and the renderings merged after every run (`קינות-על-ערים/renderings.md` §9). The strongest finds were again phrases visible only through one-to-one renderings: Lam 2:6 and Isa 1:8 five lines apart (LU 122, 127–128), both halves of Ps 89:35 (LU 167–168), Isa 55:10–11 reversed (LU 149, 411), Deut 33:9's list with its verb (LU 402–405), Amos 8:9's three words (LU 188–190), Gen 3:17–19 in the curse of Agade's clay (CA 231–236), Dan 4's seven years and the tree cut at its roots (CA 92, 115–117).
- **Seven sequential sub-agents finished the Gudea Cylinders A and B** (2026-10-20), one column group each, with the renderings merged after every run (`בניין-המקדש/renderings.md` §9.1–§9.7) and the coordinator correcting one cross-corpus collision per run on average (*šu-nir* `דגל/נס`, *esi*, *li*, four tool gates). The strongest finds came again from one-to-one renderings and reserved Bible words: Ezekiel's `צורה` and Daniel's `פשר` where the English has "plan" and "interpret"; Ps 132:3–5 in Nanše's reading of the birds; Hag 2:18–19 in the promise of abundance; the stela named in two words as at Bethel; 1 Kgs 8:13 in the builder's report; Ezra 6:15's date; Isa 24:2's two pairs in the festival of equality; Num 27:8 and Isa 1:17 in the builder's justice; *nam tar* where Solomon blesses.

H4. Changelog

- **2026-10-16** – Created. Source collection for the Mesopotamian flood narratives (Gilgameš XI, Atrahasis, Sumerian Flood Story, Berossus) and reference tools; `ebl_fetch.py`; copyright policy; principles and formats. First project: `סיפור-המבול--XI-גילגמש/` (not yet started).
- **2026-10-16** – The user asked for the *full* flood story and every other Mesopotamian flood story. The project was reorganized as a **corpus** (`סיפורי-המבול-המסופוטמיים/`, with `corpus.md` and shared `renderings.md`; §2, §6.6) of six projects: Atra-ḫasīs I–III, Gilg. XI 1–208, the Sumerian Flood Story, the other Akkadian versions (Ark, C_0, Nippur, Ugarit, Ḫattuša, W, BM 38917, U, z), Berossus + Abydenus, and flood references (nine texts). They were drafted by parallel sessions, then harmonized. New sources: eBL Atra-ḫasīs OB I, SB I–III, MB; Erra I; Gilg. I; the LXX; the Uruk sages list; the Dynastic Chronicle. New tool: `check_bible_quotes.py`. `ebl_fetch.py` fixed. Lessons added to §4.6, §5, §6.4, §6.7, §10 and §11. Niqqud and Uruk were confirmed by the user.
- **2026-10-16** – Added the print stubs (7.4§ ,`הדפסה/`, workflow step 9) at the user's request, and created them for the six flood-corpus translations.
- **2026-10-16** – New corpus **`סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/`** (corpus.md, shared renderings that inherit the flood corpus's, parallels-index.md). Project 1: **Enūma eliš I–VII**, 1,098 lines, from eBL `L/1/2` (new source, §4.4a; King 1902 and Langdon 1923 added), drafted tablet by tablet by sequential sub-agents with three review passes each, verified by script, print stub created. `ebl_fetch.py` fixed (variant reconstructions). Lessons added to §5, §6.7, §10, §11.

- **2026-10-17** – Creation corpus **project 2, the creation and Eden companions** (`סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/2-טקסטי-בריאה-ועדן/`): Adapa (MB + SB), Enki and Ninḫursaĝa (with the Ur manuscript), Enki and Ninmaḫ, the Song of the Hoe, Grain and Sheep (whole), the bilingual Founding of Eridu (BM 93014) and KAR 4 – 1,076 lines, by sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, verified by script, parallels merged into the corpus index, renderings merged (corpus §5), print stub. New sources (§4.4b): eBL Adapa; ETCSL 1.1.1, 1.1.2, 5.3.2, 5.5.4; ORACC Q000332/P346086/Q000333/Q000778 with morph; eBL fragmentarium BM 93014, VAT 9307, K 4175; SEAL 1557, 1600. New tool `seal2md.py`; `cdl2md.py --morph`; `check_bible_quotes.py` fixed (יהושע resolved as הושע); the corpus parallels builder reads project 2. Lessons added to §5, §6.7, §6.8, §10, §11.
- **2026-10-17** – New corpus `חוקים-ובריתות/` (cuneiform law and treaty; corpus.md, shared renderings with the treaty and oath terms and a reserved-word list, parallels-index.md keyed to Deuteronomy by chapter). Project 1: **Esarhaddon's Succession Treaty** (SAA 2 6, 691 entries) with the **Tell Tayinat copy** (SAA 2 15, variants in the apparatus, Tayinat-only lines tagged `{תיינת}`), drafted in seven parts by sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, verified by `verify.py`, translation built, 771 parallels rows, print stub. New source (§4.4c): ORACC SAAo saa02 Q009186 + P500551. New tool `oracc_html2tr.py`; `cdl2md.py --norm`. Lessons added to §5, §6.7, §10, §11.
- **2026-10-17** – Law and treaty corpus **project 2, the Laws of Hammurabi** (`חוקים-ובריתות/2-חוקי-חמורבי/`): all 3,641 composite lines (prologue, §1–§65, end of §100, §101–§282, epilogue; the gap laws §66–§99 not in the base text, recorded) from CDLI P464358, aligned with the Louvre stele P249253 and checked against SEAL 7520, by twelve sequential sub-agents in priority order, three review passes each, verified by script, translation built, 1,263 parallels rows merged into the corpus index with key findings, print stub. Corpus renderings §5 (shared law terms). New sources (§4.4d); new tool `cdli_composite2md.py`; `check_bible_quotes.py` fixed (Chronicles); new corpus parallels builder. Lessons added to §5, §6.7, §10, §11.
- **2026-10-18** – New corpus `אפוס-גילגמש/` (corpus.md, shared renderings inheriting Gilg. XI 1–208 and the flood, creation and law corpora, merged after every run; parallels-index.md with key findings; `translator-brief.md`; tools `gilg_config.py`, `parallels_for.py`, `verify.py`, `build_translation.py`, `build_parallels_index.py`). Project 1: **the SB epic, Tablets I–X, XI 209–328, XII** (2,474 lines; the combined translation embeds the flood corpus's XI 1–208). Project 2: **the OB tablets** VA+BM, II, III, Schøyen$_2$, Nippur, Harmal$_1$, Ishchali, Harmal$_2$, IM (743 lines). Thirteen sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, verified by script, 1,806 parallels rows, print stubs. Flood corpus §6 Gilg. I 7, 26 harmonized (*niṣirtu* = נְצוּרָה). New sources (§4.4e): eBL SB II–X, XII and nine OB chapters; SEAL OB nodes. Lessons added to §5, §6.7, §10, §11.

- **2026-10-18** – Law and treaty corpus **projects 3–7, the other law collections**: the Laws of Eshnunna (195 lines, CDLI P480696 with exemplars A, B, C), the Middle Assyrian Laws A (828 lines, ORACC tcma P281779) and B (245 lines, P281780), the Laws of Lipit-Ištar (503 lines, CDLI P464355, Sumerian) and of Ur-Namma (628 lines, CDLI P432130, Sumerian; § concordance with Roth by content) – 2,399 lines by nine sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, LH's formulas enforced by script across the collections, translations built, 678 parallels rows merged with key findings, print stubs. Corpus renderings §6 (shared terms of projects 3–7, Sumerian = the Hebrew of the Akkadian equivalent); `translator-brief--laws.md`. New sources (§4.4f); new tools `laws_config.py`, `laws_build_data.py`, `laws_verify.py`, `laws_build_translation.py`, `laws_lookup.py`; `build_parallels_index.py` reads all projects. Lessons added to §5, §6.7, §10.
- **2026-10-18** – The user delegated all open decisions to the coordinator. Gilgameš: *saḫāru* = `חָזַר` also in flood XI 150, 153, 156; VII 205 *šasû* with a tablet = `קָרָא בְּקוֹל` (as I 27); *dumqu* "beauty" = `נוֹי` (VI 6, XI 252); flood XI 160 `צברתי` kept; the rest confirmed (`אפוס-גילגמש/renderings.md` §12). Law corpus: the translators' choices confirmed, LH §66–99 deferred (`חוקים-ובריתות/corpus.md`). Lesson (§6.4): when a word is reserved for a root, a sense of the Akkadian that the reserved word expresses best (reading aloud = `קרא`) still goes by meaning.
- **2026-10-19** – The user's interest is wider than the Bible: "the soul of the ancient". §1 now states this as a second purpose of equal standing (texts are chosen and annotated also for what they show of the ancient mind), §7.2 asks for notes on the text's own world, and `curated-translation-candidates.md` no longer treats Tier 3 as low priority.
- **2026-10-19** – Creation corpus **projects 3–4** (round 2, run 1): **the Debate between Bird and Fish** (ETCSL 5.3.5, all 189 lines; `הציפור-והדג-3/`) and **Enki and the World Order** (ETCSL 1.1.3 / ORACC Q000334, all 465 lines in two files, 250–472 first; `אנקי-וסדר-העולם-4/`), three sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, verified by script, translations generated, 255 parallels rows merged into the corpus index with key findings for Gen 1:14, 1:20–23, Gen 4, Gen 10–11 and Deut 32:8, print stubs. Corpus renderings §6 (fixed before drafting), §7–§8 (merged). New sources (§4.4g); new tools `tools/sumerian_workbench.py`, `sumerian_tools.py`, `translator-brief--sumerian.md`. Lessons added to §5, §6.7, §10. `curated-translation-candidates.md`: "Round 2 plan (2026-10-19)".
- **2026-10-19** – New corpus `ספרות-החכמה-והצדיק-הסובל/` (round 2, run 2): **Ludlul bēl nēmeqi I–V** (eBL `L/2/2`, 534 labels, five files) and **the Babylonian Theodicy** (eBL `L/2/1`, 288 labels, two files), six sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, verified by `wisdom_tools.py verify --strict`, translations generated, parallels merged into `parallels-index.md` (Job first) with key findings, print stubs. Corpus renderings (fixed before drafting; merged after every run, §10). New sources (§4.4h): eBL Ludlul and Theodicy, Lenzi 2023 (OBO 300, open access), CCP 1.3 and 1.4, records-only folder; §4.6 ZORA and CCP access. New tools `wisdom_config.py`, `wisdom_tools.py`, `build_parallels_index.py`, `translator-brief.md` (§10). Lessons added to §5, §6.7, §11.

- **2026-10-20** – New corpus `קינות-על-ערים/` (round 2, run 3): **the Lament for Ur** (ETCSL 2.2.2 / ORACC Q000379, all 442 lines, eleven *kirugu*, three files) and **the Curse of Agade** (ETCSL 2.1.5 / ORACC Q000375, the 284 OB lines and the 37 lines of the Ur III version, two files), five sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, verified by `lament_tools.py verify --strict`, translations generated, 475 parallels rows merged into `parallels-index.md` (Lamentations first) with key findings, print stubs. Corpus renderings fixed before drafting (refrains, Emesal, reserved genre-words) and merged after every run (§9). New sources (§4.4i): ETCSL 2.2.2, 2.1.5; ORACC Q000379, Q000375; Kramer 1940 (ISAC, open); records-only folder (Samet 2014, Cooper 1983 lending-only). New tools `lament_tools.py`, `build_parallels_index.py`, `translator-brief--laments.md` (§10). Lessons added to §5, §6.7, §11.
- **2026-10-20** – New corpus `בניין-המקדש/` (round 2, run 4): **the Gudea Cylinders A and B** (ETCSL 2.1.7 / ORACC epsd2-royal Q000377, all 1,300 lines in seven files, RIME labels `A.i.1`–`B.xxiv.17`, concordance verified by script), seven sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, verified by `temple_tools.py verify GU --strict`, translation generated (120 footnotes), 561 parallels rows (Exodus first) with key findings, print stub. Corpus renderings fixed before drafting (the reserved Tabernacle words, the gated building words, the Ur-Namma justice formula) and merged after every run (§9). New sources (§4.4j): ETCSL 2.1.7, ORACC Q000377 (epsd2-royal; ETCSRI translation, CC BY-SA), Thureau-Dangin 1905/1907 (public domain), records-only folder (Edzard 1997, Hurowitz 1992 …). New tools `temple_tools.py` (incl. `conc`, `data`), `build_parallels_index.py`, `translator-brief--temple.md` (§10). Lessons added to §5, §6.7, §11.
- **2026-10-21** – §5.1 added: the pace of local sessions (quota-limited, one agent at a time) vs. Claude Cloud sessions (a special allowance, so no quotas expected: full speed, parallel sub-agents across independent texts, with the corpus safeguards kept). Any limit met in the cloud is to be recorded in §5.1.
- **2026-10-21** – Preparing for Claude Cloud: `STATUS.md` (the handoff file: what is done, what is next, the run brief, the cross-corpus open decisions), `tools/sources_sync.py` with `sources/fetch-recipes.tsv` and the generated `sources/MANIFEST.json` (238 items; re-obtains the git-ignored sources and checks them; §8, §10), access notes in §4.6.
- **2026-10-21** – The guidelines split, at the user's request, into a lean core (`translation-guidelines.md`, 213 KB → 66 KB: what a working session needs) and three sibling files: `sources-registry.md` (§4, §9), `tools.md` (§10), and this file (the per-run accounts, the former §11, the changelog). The per-run lessons are distilled into the core's new §5.2 (★ = rules for every translator's brief); section numbers are kept, with pointers, so existing "§N" references still resolve. The box-drawn tables became Markdown tables.

- **2026-10-21** – Claude Cloud: ORACC sends its TLS certificate without the intermediate, so curl and Python both failed there (exit 60 / `CERTIFICATE_VERIFY_FAILED`) and `sources_sync.py fetch` lost 9 ORACC files. The public intermediate (*InCommon RSA Server CA 2*) is now in `tools/certs/`, and `sources_sync.py` adds it on a certificate error (verification stays on); `sources-registry.md` §4.6 and `tools.md` updated. Round 2, runs 5–7 started as three parallel coordinators (the first parallel cloud round).
- **2026-10-21** – New corpus `העולם-התחתון/` (round 2, run 5): **the Descent of Ištar** (eBL `L/1/8`, SB + NA, all 159 entries) and **Inana's Descent** (ETCSL 1.4.1 / ORACC Q000343, all 440 entries, two files), one Hebrew for the shared formulas of the two languages, three review passes each, `netherworld_tools.py` (verify / build / lines / grep), `build_parallels_index.py` (tables generated from the annotations), print stubs; translated by the coordinator (no sub-agent tool in the session). Lessons added to §5.2, §6.7; §5.1 notes that sub-agents cannot start sub-agents, and how the lead synced after the history rewrite of `main`.